

Question Bank and PYQs

Economics Chapter 1 - Development

2 Mark Questions

Q1: What does development mean to different people? Support your answer with examples. (2 Marks)

- Development or progress means different things to different people because their life situations and aspirations vary.
- For a landless rural labourer, development means more days of work and better wages.
- For a girl from a rich urban family, it means getting as much freedom as her brother and being able to decide her own path in life.

Q2: Mention two non-material goals that people seek for development. (2 Marks)

- Besides higher income, people seek non-material things like equal treatment, freedom, security, and respect from others.
- They also value the absence of discrimination and the opportunity to live a life with dignity.

Q3: Define 'Average Income' or 'Per Capita Income' as used by the World Bank. (2 Marks)

- Average Income, also known as Per Capita Income, is the total income of a country divided by its total population.
- The World Bank uses this criterion in its World Development Reports to classify countries into rich, middle-income, and low-income categories.

Q4: What is meant by 'Literacy Rate'? (2 Marks)

- Literacy Rate measures the proportion of the literate population in the 7-and-above age group.
- It is an important indicator of the educational development of a region or state.

Q5: Define 'Infant Mortality Rate' (IMR). (2 Marks)

- Infant Mortality Rate indicates the number of children that die before completing one year of age as a proportion of 1000 live children born in that particular year.
- A lower IMR is a sign of better healthcare and nutritional status in a state.

Q6: What is 'Net Attendance Ratio' at the secondary stage? (2 Marks)

- Net Attendance Ratio is the total number of children in the age group of 15–17 years attending school as a percentage of the total number of children in that same age group.
- It reflects the level of educational participation among adolescents.

Q10: Mention two examples of environmental degradation observed today. (2 Marks)

- Serious threat of groundwater overuse in many parts of India, leading to declining water levels.
- Toxic waste dumping in cities or the sea, causing symptoms of poisoning and death among the local population.

3 Mark Questions



Q7: Why is income alone not a sufficient indicator of development? (3 Marks)

- Income by itself is an inadequate indicator because money in your pocket cannot buy all the goods and services required to live well, such as a pollution-free environment.
- Quality of life also depends on non-material factors like freedom, security, and equal treatment which cannot be measured solely in terms of money.

Q8: How does UNDP's Human Development Report compare countries? (3 Marks)

- UNDP compares countries based on three main criteria: educational levels of the people, their health status, and their per capita income.
- This approach is more comprehensive than the World Bank's method, which relies only on income.

Q9: What is the importance of 'Sustainability' in development? (3 Marks)

- Sustainability is desirable so that the present level of development can be maintained for future generations.

- It ensures that we do not exhaust natural resources like groundwater and minerals, which are finite.

Q11: Explain the statement: 'What may be development for one may not be development for the other.' (3 Marks)

- Developmental goals often conflict because what is beneficial for one person might be harmful for another.
- For example, industrialists may want more dams to generate electricity for their factories.
- However, these dams submerge land and disrupt the lives of tribals who are displaced, making the dam destructive for them.
- Thus, development for the industrialist is displacement and loss for the tribal.

Q12: Why do people look at a mix of goals rather than just income for development? (3 Marks)

- While income is important, the quality of our life also depends on non-material things like equal treatment, freedom, and security.
- A high-paying job with no security and no time for family may be less desirable than a job with lower pay but regular employment and a safe working atmosphere.
- For instance, if women are engaged in paid work, their dignity increases, but they also need sharing of housework and a safe environment.
- Therefore, developmental goals include both better income and other important aspects of life.

Q13: Critically examine the World Bank's criterion for classifying countries. (3 Marks)

- The World Bank uses Per Capita Income as the sole criterion for classifying countries into rich and poor.
- The main limitation of this method is that it uses averages, which can hide disparities within a country.
- Two countries might have the same average income, but one could have a more equitable distribution while the other has a few extremely rich people and many poor ones.
- It does not account for other critical factors like health, literacy, or life expectancy.

Q14: Compare the developmental status of Haryana and Kerala based on the indicators provided in the text. (3 Marks)

- Haryana has a much higher per capita income (*Rs* 2, 64, 729) compared to Kerala (*Rs* 2, 34, 405).
- However, Kerala performs much better in social indicators: its Infant Mortality Rate is only 6 per 1000, while Haryana's is 28.
- Kerala's literacy rate is 94%, whereas Haryana's is 82%; Kerala also has a much higher Net Attendance Ratio (94) than Haryana (73).
- This shows that income alone does not determine development, as Kerala's better health and education facilities lead to higher human development.

Q15: Why is collective provision of services often better than individual provision? (3 Marks)

- Collective provision is the cheapest and most effective way to provide important services like security, education, and health.
- For example, it is cheaper to have one security guard for a whole locality than for every house to hire its own guard.
- Similarly, a child can study because the government opens schools for all, as many parents cannot afford private schools elsewhere.
- The Public Distribution System (PDS) is also more effective when managed by the government for the benefit of the whole community.

Q16: Explain the concept of 'Body Mass Index' (BMI) and its significance. (3 Marks)

- BMI is a simple measure used by nutrition scientists to determine if an adult is properly nourished, underweight, or overweight.
- It is calculated by dividing an individual's weight in kilograms by the square of their height in meters ($BMI = \frac{kg}{m^2}$).
- According to the text, a person with a BMI below 18.5 is considered undernourished.
- This indicator helps in assessing the nutritional status of a population, as seen in the comparison between states like Kerala and Madhya Pradesh.

Q17: How do averages hide disparities? Use the example of Countries A and B from the text. (3 Marks)

- Averages are useful for comparison but they do not show how income is distributed among people.
- In Country A, income is equitably distributed, and people are neither very rich nor extremely poor.
- In Country B, four people earn only *Rs* 500 each, while the fifth person earns *Rs* 48,000, making most citizens poor despite a high average.
- Both countries have the same average income, but Country A is preferred because it lacks the extreme inequality of Country B.

Q18: What is the role of the Public Distribution System (PDS) in development? (3 Marks)

- The PDS ensures the availability of essential food items at fair prices to the public.
- States where the PDS functions well, such as Tamil Nadu, have better health and nutritional status among their people.
- Conversely, in states where only a small percentage uses ration shops, the nutritional well-being of the poor is often at risk.
- It serves as a critical public facility that mitigates the effects of low income on a family's nutrition.

Q19: Distinguish between renewable and non-renewable resources with examples. (3 Marks)

- Renewable resources are those replenished by nature, such as groundwater, crops, and plants.
- However, even these can be overused if consumption exceeds the rate of natural replenishment.
- Non-renewable resources, like crude oil or coal, have a fixed stock on earth and will get exhausted after a few years of use.
- Unlike renewable resources, non-renewable ones cannot be replenished once they are consumed.

Q20: Explain why the issue of sustainability is important for development. (3 Marks)

- Sustainability is vital because current patterns of development may lead to the exhaustion of resources needed by future generations.

- Environmental degradation, like pollution or water scarcity, does not respect national boundaries and affects the future of everyone.
- Sustainability forces us to reconsider the nature of progress and ensure that we are not living at the expense of our descendants.
- It is a new area of knowledge requiring collaboration between scientists, economists, and philosophers.

5 Mark Questions

Q21: Discuss the different developmental goals of various categories of persons as listed in Table 1.1 of the NCERT text. (5 Marks)

- Developmental goals are highly subjective and vary based on a person's current life situation and needs.
- Landless rural labourers prioritize 'more days of work' and 'better wages' to sustain their families, along with quality education for their children and social equality in the village.
- Prosperous farmers from Punjab seek 'high family income' through higher support prices for crops and 'hardworking and cheap labourers' to maximize their profit and settle children abroad.
- A girl from a rich urban family aspires for 'freedom' equal to her brother and the ability to pursue studies abroad, highlighting gender equality as a developmental goal.
- Urban unemployed youth primarily seek job security and stable income opportunities.
- An adivasi from the Narmada valley would prioritize the protection of their land and water resources, often opposing large projects like the Sardar Sarovar Dam.

Q22: 'Money in your pocket cannot buy all the goods and services that you may need to live well.' Justify the statement with examples from the chapter. (5 Marks)

- While income is a crucial factor for living, it is not a complete indicator of material and social well-being.
- Firstly, money cannot buy a pollution-free environment or ensure that you receive unadulterated medicines.

- Secondly, money cannot protect a person from infectious diseases unless the whole community takes preventive steps collectively.
- Thirdly, individual money cannot provide public goods like schools, hospitals, or security as efficiently or cheaply as collective provision.
- Fourthly, non-material things like equal treatment, freedom, security, and the respect of others are essential for a good life but cannot be purchased.
- Lastly, even if one is wealthy, their quality of life suffers if their community lacks basic facilities like electricity or a functioning Public Distribution System.

Q23: Analyze the developmental criteria used by the UNDP (Human Development Report) and compare it with the World Bank's World Development Report. (5 Marks)

- The World Bank uses only 'Average Income' or 'Per Capita Income' to classify countries, which focuses solely on economic growth.
- The UNDP's Human Development Report is more comprehensive, comparing countries based on educational levels, health status, and per capita income.
- Health is measured by 'Life Expectancy at birth', indicating the average expected length of life of a person at birth.
- Education is measured by 'Mean Years of Schooling' of people aged 25 and above.
- Income is measured as 'Gross National Income (GNI) per capita' in Purchasing Power Parity (PPP \$) so that it can be compared across countries accurately. By adding the 'Human' prefix to 'Development', being and health of citizens are the ultimate goal of progress.

Q24: Examine the issue of sustainability of development with the help of the examples of groundwater and crude oil. (5 Marks)

- Sustainability means developing today without compromising the needs of future generations, a concern raised as many current practices are unsustainable.
- Example 1: Groundwater is a renewable resource, but it is under serious threat of overuse in India.
- About one-third of the country is overusing groundwater reserves; if this continues, 60% of the country will face a crisis in 25 years.

- Example 2: Crude oil is a non-renewable resource with fixed stocks that cannot be replenished.
- Global reserves are estimated to last only about 50 years at the present rate of extraction, posing a burden for countries like India that depend on imports.
- Sustainability requires us to manage renewable resources properly and shift away from total dependence on non-renewable ones to ensure future progress.

Q25: Explain the significance of health and education indicators in comparing states, with reference to Haryana, Kerala, and Bihar. (5 Marks)

- Per capita income is not the only attribute of development; health and education indicators are equally important for human well-being.
- Data for 2020–2021 shows that while Haryana has a higher per capita income (*Rs* 2, 64, 729) than Kerala (*Rs* 2, 34, 405), it lags behind in social parameters.
- Kerala's low Infant Mortality Rate (6) compared to Haryana's (28) indicates superior basic healthcare and nutritional facilities.
- Kerala's literacy rate (94%) is significantly higher than Haryana's (82%) and Bihar's (62%), reflecting better educational investment.
- In Bihar, nearly one-third of children aged 15–17 are not attending school, which shows a massive gap in educational attainment despite some income growth.
- This analysis proves that high income does not automatically guarantee high-quality social services like health and education.

Q26: How can the notions of national development be conflicting? Explain with suitable examples from the text. (5 Marks)

- Different persons have different developmental goals, and these notions for a country can be conflicting.
- A project like the Sardar Sarovar Dam on the Narmada River is seen as development by industrialists for power and by some farmers for irrigation.
- However, for the local tribals, the same project is destructive as it submerges their land and destroys their livelihoods.

- Another conflict is seen in toxic waste dumping; a multinational company may benefit by saving costs, but the local people suffer from poisoning and death.
- A girl may want the same freedom as her brother, but the brother may not like the change in domestic dynamics.
- National development means thinking about these conflicts and finding a path that is fair and just for the majority of the population.

Q27: Analyze the educational achievements of the rural population of Uttar Pradesh based on Table 1.5 and the text. (5 Marks)

- The data reveals a significant disparity in literacy rates between males and females in rural Uttar Pradesh.
- The overall literacy rate for the rural population is 76% for males but only 54% for females.
- Among children in the age group of 10–14 years, the literacy rate is higher (90% for males, 87% for females), showing improvement over time.
- However, not all literate children attend school; the percentage attending school in this age group is 85% for boys and 82% for girls.
- This implies that 15% of rural boys and 18% of rural girls are still not attending school even in the younger age bracket.
- The high level of illiteracy and school dropout rates even after 75 years of independence remains a disturbing developmental challenge.

Q28: Using Table 1.6, compare the performance of India and its neighbors in human development indicators. (5 Marks)

- The Human Development Index (HDI) ranking for 2021–22 shows that Sri Lanka (78) and Bangladesh (129) are ranked higher than India (134).
- Sri Lanka is ahead of India in every respect: higher GNI per capita (11,899), higher life expectancy (76.6), and more years of schooling (11.2).
- Interestingly, even countries with lower GNI per capita than India, like Nepal (4,026) and Bangladesh (6,511), have better performance in life expectancy (70.5 and 73.7 respectively) than India (67.7).

- Bangladesh also has a higher mean years of schooling (7.4) compared to India (6.5).
- Pakistan lags behind India in most parameters, including GNI per capita (5,374), life expectancy (66.4), and schooling (4.4).
- The data emphasizes that a country's size and total wealth do not automatically translate into better human development for its citizens.

Q29: What are public facilities? Why are they necessary for the development of a country? (5 Marks)

- Public facilities are essential goods and services provided collectively by the government or society for the well-being of all citizens.
- They are necessary because private individuals cannot always afford essential services like education, health, and clean water on their own.
- Collective provision, such as government schools, allows children from poor families to study, which is vital for a country's literacy and progress.
- Health facilities like vaccination programs and sanitation are effective only when provided at the community level to prevent diseases.
- The Public Distribution System (PDS) is a public facility that ensures food security and nutrition for the poor at affordable prices.
- In states like Kerala, the availability of these facilities has led to a much higher quality of life despite lower income levels.

Q30: Discuss the relevance of the statement: 'The Earth has enough resources to meet the needs of all but not enough to satisfy the greed of even one person.' (5 Marks)

- This statement highlights the critical need for sustainability and equitable resource distribution in development.
- The earth provides renewable resources like water and soil that can support human needs indefinitely if managed responsibly.
- However, modern industrial 'greed' leads to the overuse of resources, such as the dangerous depletion of groundwater reserves in 300 districts of India.
- Non-renewable resources like crude oil are being extracted at rates that will exhaust them within 50 years, causing potential global crises.

- The statement suggests that environmental degradation is not a failure of the planet but a failure of human management and over-consumption.
- True development means finding a path that meets the basic needs of all citizens without over-exploiting nature for the sake of excessive luxury.

